



LEARNER/EMPLOYER HANDBOOK





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WELCOME

Welcome to our training centre, Dental Nurse Training (DNT). Our Diploma in Dental Nursing course will prepare trainee dental nurses in the foundation of dental nursing, so they can demonstrate the highest standards in terms of knowledge, skills and personal attributes and they will become safe beginners.

Our postgraduate courses help nurses develop professionally either in the area of Oral Health Education, as an IR(ME)R operator to safely take intra-oral and extra-oral radiographs of patients or to apply topical fluoride safely to a range of age groups.

Learners benefit from constant assessment throughout their training to ensure they are confident and ready when it is time to sit their exams.

There is a learning needs section on the application form for a learner to identify any additional support they feel they may need before beginning the course and we also provide a pre enrolment questionnaire to all our learners. All information is kept strictly confidential.

At DNT we pride ourselves on looking after each learner as an individual and we hope that we are supportive yet transparent in our approach to training you every step of the way.

LEARNER RECRUITMENT & INDUCTION

Dental Nurse Training is committed to ensuring an equal and fair opportunity for learners to enrol onto NEBDN accredited courses. We ask all our staff involved in the provision and support of training to maintain and promote a fair and consistent approach to learner recruitment.

Dental Nurse Training recognises the importance of ensuring learners are enrolled onto the right pathway for training and are already under the employment of a dental practice. A tailored Induction takes place with the employer and learner to ensure learners have a supportive practice and the ability to meet the requirements of the course whilst working.

All learners need to be in employment and have had a formal structured induction process at the practice where they work. Employers need to ensure learners have followed or are following the mandatory immunisation route for Dental Nurses. Employers need to complete a Service Monitoring Agreement and appoint a mentor and GDC witness for the learners' training before they commence the course.

At the induction stage, learners are provided with clear and comprehensive information outlining the course specification, structure, and modules. This includes details on assessment methods, revision guidance, examination procedures, and the course timetable, as well as the role of the practice in supporting the learner. All course fees and the full terms and conditions of Dental Nurse Training (DNT) are shared in advance, prior to enrolment.

If a learner transfers to us partway through the completion of their POE/ROC, we will ask the learner to share their workbook with us to determine the progress/completion of their workbook.

DNT will check each piece of work that has been signed off with their current centre to ensure it has a valid witness certificate but we will not check the content of the learner's work as this has been signed off by the previous centre. A comment will be made in the assessor comments section to reflect this.

IDENTIFICATION

Please ensure you thoroughly read the application form when enrolling on a course. It advises on the acceptable forms of identification (ID) that you will have to present. The photo ID used must match the name that learners use during the training and examinations and it will be the name printed on the qualification certificates. Supporting documentation will need to be provided to the training centre to confirm a name change once the course has begun, we can then inform the NEBDN and update exam entry documents.

**INDUCTION CHECKLIST**

Induction	Members of the team involved with training, Contact Information of the training team, Documents to complete, and targets to meet Induction Session Personalised Induction Session for each practice covering all mandatory documents, witnesses, SMA Course Timetable/Schedule
NEBDN	Details of NEBDN as Awarding Body Exam Structure Target Date for Examination
Record of Competence/Experience	POE/ROC on PebblePad Responsibilities of Learner, Witness Assessor, Internal Quality assurer Witness Toolkit Key ROC/POE Dates
Course Structure	Programme Dates/Time (Timetable) Details of Assessment methods Mock Exam/Revision Details
Course Policies	Policies relevant to the entire training programme Website Resources Uploaded induction presentation to Dental Nurse Training Website Details of course textbooks provided Learner Handbook (Policies and Procedures) Dental Nurse Training Fees/NEBDN Fee guides Dental Nurse Training Pebblepad Presentation Video Dental Nurse Training PebblePocket Presentation Video POE Competition Guidance
Initial Assessment	Standardised Target Plan for Learners as online course Bespoke training plan – Communications with learners if plan deviates from outline Tracking on Pebblepad ROC work schedules to be provided for post-cert courses at induction session
Feedback	Progress Reports Post Course Evaluation

COURSE STRUCTURE**SELF-DIRECTED LEARNING**

Learners will be responsible for taking notes during online modules and for making up their own folder of information. Learners will be responsible for home study using the recommended textbooks outlined in the course area along with lecture notes available on the website, learners may also choose to research away from the recommended material and this is encouraged as long as learners ensure the information they source is



factual. A regular online presence is expected of everyone that trains with us. All Learners taking on any qualification are expected to set regular time aside to study at home on a weekly basis.

EMPLOYERS' RESPONSIBILITIES TO AID POE/ROC COMPLETION

Employers should consider allowing adequate time for the learner to complete some of their ROC/POE within work time, where possible. We do not set the amount of time employers need to give, but consideration should be taken of how long the learners working hours are, travel time to and from work and family commitments such as children. These considerations make the learners experience during training less stressful if they have been supported well. As a centre we also understand this can only be given within reason and pressures on practices are increasing. When an ROC/POE is completed all revision should be completed in the learners own time.

LEARNER IDENTIFICATION

Trainee dental nurses should be clearly identifiable to patients to state what qualification they are undertaking. This can either be through an ID badge, or through a poster identifying a trainee is present and may be assisting in a procedure. Patient consent must be given.

MENTOR

This is the person that is accepting the overall responsibility for the learner throughout their training, they provide pastoral support to learners. They may or may not also be a witness. The name person/mentor will be the person we report to as a centre throughout the training and we like the mentor to be in a position to make decisions if we need to contact them if a learner is not progressing as they should or if extra support has been requested.

CLINICAL PROGRESS REPORTS

Reports are sent to the mentors throughout the duration of each course (2 reports for the post registration courses and 4 reports for the diploma courses, 1 for topical fluoride). The progress reports are essential as they provide feedback from the assessor, mentor and learners. They form an overview of the learners progression and involve the whole training team.

These reports are stored on the learners file and kept should they be requested by any professional bodies in the future such as the GDC, Ofqual or NEBDN. Clinical progress reports must be returned to the training centre within 7 days of receipt.

WITNESS VERIFICATION

The Role of a witness is to watch a procedure carried out by a learner that they need to write an account of for their POE/ROC progress. Witnesses only accept responsibility for that one directly witnessed event.

The NEBDN accept responsibility for all witnessing for the regulated Diploma course now but the post-certificate courses we as a centre are still responsible for these.

For the regulated diploma course you will provide one main witness and this name is passed onto the NEBDN, any additional witnesses you wish to add will be done via the witness we have provided and all training is given by the NEBDN. For the post certificate courses each person who will witness within your practice needs to be added to the Service Monitoring Agreement and added to our Internal system before they are able to sign off any work. This is all covered in the induction. All post certificate witnesses have to understand their role as a witness and they will be required to sign a **witness confirmation sheet** that will be returned to us and saved in the learners file.

If any appropriately qualified dental nurses will be supervising the learners taking the post-qualification courses, they must provide a copy of their post-qualification certificates to the training centre at the beginning of the course before they witness the learner.



Any changes/Additions mid-course to the witnesses should be relayed to the course administrator, who will then make amendments and approve the changes. The Learner will be emailed when the new witness is approved, and they can then begin witnessing.

A copy of the NEBDN witness toolkit is sent to the witnesses and learners. This must be read and fully understood before any GDC registrant commences a witnessing role. A witness must understand that their GDC registration is at risk if a false account is submitted.

POE/ROC AND WORK SCHEDULES

The purpose of the POE/ROCs are to ensure learners receive summative assessments carried out in the workplace to an approved standard. They are composed of a series of various assessments for the regulated diploma and practical competence assessment sheet for the post certificate courses (PCAS), covering all areas of general dentistry or the course they are completing. They provide a written record of the learner's performance during the relevant clinical procedures that they refer to, and indicate whether that performance was competent or not. Many of these procedures are witnessed in the practice by pre-approved team members but some pieces of work called supplementary outcomes do not require witnessing, for the regulated diploma learners will produce various different forms of work to complement their POE.

Whilst delivering patient care within your practice, it is mandatory to obtain and record informed consent. Consent may be obtained in different ways, dependant on how your practice operates and the system it uses. A record of the consent needs to be included in your online work. This also needs to be indicated on pebblepad.

A tracking document is used as a record of progress. These are completed by learner and assessor, these must be kept up to date at all times to ensure good workflow and completion within the indicated time constraints.

To succeed in the course and gain entry to the NEBDN Examinations, learners must pass all units and must demonstrate sufficient knowledge or competence throughout the POE/ROC.

At the start of the course, all post-certificate learners will be provided with a Record of Competence (ROC) work schedule by their assessor. Learners are expected to complete the online modules within three months. If the modules are not completed within this timeframe, the course will be paused. Failure to complete them within an additional four weeks may result in withdrawal from the programme.

The ROC work schedule is reviewed regularly before the final ROC submission deadline and may be adjusted to support the learner in catching up. At this stage, the learner's mentor will also be contacted and informed of any concerns regarding progress.

If the assessor believes the learner is unlikely to meet the required standards in time for the exam, a mandatory deferral will be issued at the cost of the learner or the practice. If sufficient progress has not made in the time since enrolled onto the programme, the learner may be formally withdrawn from the course.

The diploma course has a different structure and learners are provided with their submission deadlines directly from their assessor.

Dental Nurse Training Ltd hope that you have a fulfilled career with the employer that you are with.

From time to time, learners move mid-training. If a learner finds themselves in this unfortunate position, please discuss your situation with us before doing so. If you do not discuss this beforehand, you may not be aware of deadlines and timeframes. There are charges for learners who move mid-training and in addition to this it can lead to complications completing your POE/ROC, which in rare circumstances may make it impossible for you to complete your training. We can help to fully inform you of all your options before you make a final decision.



LEARNER ASSESSMENT

This policy covers Dental Nurse Training's commitment to equality of opportunity and diversity. As a Training Provider we must have in place the necessary systems and procedures to allow the provision of access arrangements, including reasonable adjustments.

These should reflect the needs of individual learners and must also ensure that assessment continues to enable a reliable and consistent approach to the achievement of learning outcomes measured against the assessment criteria.

Statement of Assessment

We aim to provide all learners with the opportunity to achieve their full potential

We will endeavour to ensure that the assessment processes are implemented in a way which is fair and non-discriminatory.

Reasonable adjustments and special considerations allow learners to show and demonstrate knowledge without changing the demands of the assessment. They allow learners with special educational needs, disabilities or special considerations to access the assessment.

All assessment of work is carried out fairly and in keeping with the NEBDNs accreditation framework and timescales

Deadlines/Timeframe for completion

For post-certificate courses, **PCAS must be written up by the learner within three days of the procedure.**

- **Witnesses** are required to complete witness statements to the standards set out in the Witness Toolkit within 14 days of the procedure.
- **Assessors** will provide marking of the first draft within 28 days of the procedure.
- Any **subsequent amendments or changes** must be completed within seven days.

These accounts are essential. They not only document surgical experience, accurate patient treatment records, and learner competency, but also provide the basis for feedback and feedforward between learners, witnesses, and assessors. Inadequate feedback from witnesses may result in work being declined, which disadvantages learners and is strongly discouraged.

Reflective learning builds upon this process, helping learners develop confidence while strengthening both their theoretical knowledge and practical skills in patient care.

Supplementary Outcomes (SO) are completed by the learner independently and do not require direct witnessing. These are often completed at home rather than in the workplace.

Continuous Assessment

Learner assessment can be in the form of computer-marked tests which are multiple choice questions (MCQs) or extended multiple choice questions (EMCQs). These can be found in each unit of the course.

Summative Assessments

The purpose of the POE/ROCs are to ensure learners receive summative assessments carried out in the workplace to an approved standard.



They are composed of a series of assessed activities covering all areas of general dentistry. They provide a written record of the learner's performance during the relevant clinical procedures that they refer to, and indicate whether that performance was satisfactory or not.

A tracking document is used as a record of progress. These are completed by learner and assessor, these must be kept up to date at all times to ensure good workflow and completion within the indicated time constraints.

To succeed in the course and gain entry to the NEBDN Examinations learners must pass all units and must demonstrate sufficient knowledge or competence throughout the POE/ROC.

Mock Exams

These are carried out and set as a real NEBDN exam experience. Online learners will need to ensure they set themselves examination conditions and the device used must have a working camera and microphone.

They are compulsory in order for us to assess if you are eligible to be entered for the NEBDN Knowledge test. Failure to attend/take them could jeopardise your entry to the examination. You will then be deferred at a cost payable by yourself or your company.

SUMMATIVE ASSESSMENTS/EXAM ENTRY

To succeed in the course and gain entry to the NEBDN Examinations, learners must demonstrate sufficient knowledge or competence throughout the POE/ROC and complete to an acceptable standard in full by the specified deadline.

DNT also provide computer marked tests which are multiple choice questions (MCQs) or extended multiple choice questions (EMCQs). These can be found in each unit of the course once each lecture has been completed. Assessors are automatically emailed the learners' results.

Mock exams are provided and carried out and set as a real NEBDN exam experience. Learners will need to ensure they set themselves examination conditions and the device used must have a working camera and microphone. Mocks are compulsory for us to assess if you are eligible to be entered for the NEBDN Knowledge/written test. Regardless of how knowledgeable a learner is, POE/ROC completion is the first step of any course. If the learner fails to complete their POE/ROC they will be deferred to the next exam.

In extreme cases, learners may be removed from the centre, every opportunity is given to a learner before this happens.

ATTENDANCE/ABSENCE

Learners should inform their assessor/training centre if they are going to be absent from any live session at least 24 hours before where possible and the reason for not being able to attend.

Learners logging on 15 minutes after the start of the session will be marked as late. In cases where a learner begins to develop a pattern of lateness and absences, the assessor will try to resolve the problem with the learner and employer. Employers are notified of every unattended session.

LEARNER CODE OF CONDUCT & EXAMINATION BEHAVIOUR

Learner Engagement Policy

At Dental Nurse Training, we are committed to maintaining high standards of learner engagement and academic responsibility. We expect all learners to approach their studies with dedication and to adhere to the timelines and requirements outlined by their assessor.



Learners who fail to meet agreed deadlines will have their training temporarily paused. Training will resume only once the assessor has received the necessary contact and evidence of progress. In some cases, this may involve a call with the learner's mentor to develop a tailored support plan.

If insufficient progress continues beyond this point, the assessor will consult with the Lead Internal Quality Assurer (IQA) to review the case. Based on this review, a decision will be made regarding the learner's continued enrolment with the centre.

Possible outcomes may include:

- A course extension, either granted as a goodwill gesture or subject to an additional fee
- Deferral of the final exam if the learner is not deemed ready
- Withdrawal from the course and removal from our training centre, a reason will be provided in line with this decision

We encourage all learners to engage proactively and communicate regularly to ensure steady progress and a successful learning experience.

Professional Behaviour Expectations

While enrolled with DNT, learners are expected to:

- Treat all staff members and fellow learners with respect
- Demonstrate politeness and courtesy in all interactions
- Conduct themselves professionally and appropriately at all times
- Communicate effectively and respectfully, acknowledging and valuing differing perspectives
- Uphold honesty and integrity in all academic work and assessments
- Engage actively in group work, both online and during one-to-one sessions
- Seek support when needed and take responsibility for their own learning
- Attend all scheduled lectures and revision sessions punctually and regularly; if online, cameras must remain on unless otherwise agreed
- Be open and honest in all communications with assessors and DNT staff
- Take ownership of independent study by creating and maintaining a structured home learning schedule, learners must not rely solely on workplace time for study; all programmes require regular weekly home learning
- Complete any required amendments to the Portfolio of evidence (POE) or Record of Competence (ROC) portfolios within the timeframe set by assessors; excessive delays may result in work being rejected and needing to be redone
- Thoroughly read and understand all communications regarding examinations, including all associated policies and guidance

Unacceptable Behaviour While Enrolled With DNT

All learners are expected to conduct themselves professionally and respectfully at all times. Behaviour that disrupts the learning environment or damages the reputation of Dental Nurse Training (DNT) will not be tolerated. Examples of unacceptable conduct include, but are not limited to:

- Engaging in disruptive, threatening, or abusive behaviour
- Bullying or harassing fellow learners or members of staff
- Being under the influence of alcohol or illegal substances
- Acting dishonestly during discussions, assessments, or examinations
- Failing to engage with DNT communications (email or text) or excessively wasting assessor time
- Failure to repeatedly meet deadlines



Any such behaviour may be deemed a breach of the learner code of conduct and could lead to disciplinary action and potential dismissal from the course.

Examination Conduct: Written and Professional discussion Examinations

To maintain the integrity of all examinations, learners must adhere to the following guidelines:

- Dress in a professional and appropriate manner
- Ensure a functioning camera and microphone are available
- Be alone in a quiet, disturbance-free room
- Place your mobile phone on silent and outside the room, only to be used if necessary to contact the NEBDN
- Attend and fully engage in the mandatory preparation session, which includes downloading and practising with Maxexam software
- Familiarise yourself with Zoom prior to the exam day
- Use your correct full name on Zoom, as registered with the NEBDN
- Have valid photographic ID ready for verification
- Only bring plain paper, a pen, and water in a clear bottle into the exam room
- Ensure no course materials are present in the exam space
- Be prepared to use your camera to show the examiner or recording the entire room setup
- Do not share any exam content or details with others in person or via social media after the exam
- Do not attempt to sell or distribute any written portfolio materials
- Refrain from any form of violent, indecent, disorderly, threatening, or disruptive behaviour
- Do not use offensive language or gestures in any oral or written communication

Consequences Of Misconduct

Any violation of this code of conduct may call into question a learner's fitness to practise and could result in disciplinary proceedings. This may jeopardise a learner's continuation on the course and their eligibility to register with the General Dental Council (GDC).

Learner Malpractice and NEBDN Investigations

Any suspected malpractice during training or NEBDN examinations is taken extremely seriously. This includes, but is not limited to:

- Unauthorised copying or distribution of examination papers and materials
- Plagiarism
- Falsifying portfolio evidence such as witness accounts or patient interactions
- Taking unauthorised materials or devices (e.g. mobile phones, smart devices) into the examination
- Accessing external support or assistance during the examination
- Communicating with others during the examination
- Any behaviour deemed to give an unfair advantage

If a learner is suspected of malpractice, the NEBDN will initiate a formal investigation. As the approved training provider, Dental Nurse Training (DNT) will be notified and may be required to:

- Gather evidence relating to the allegation (e.g. communication records, learner statements, assessment history) Including, where necessary, contacting the Learners practice
- Provide supporting documentation requested by the NEBDN
- Submit all findings to the NEBDN for review



The final decision regarding malpractice and any resulting sanctions rests solely with the NEBDN.

- Outcomes may include (but are not limited to):
- Disqualification from the examination
- Invalidation of results
- Temporary or permanent exclusion from future examinations

COMMUNICATION

The channels of communication to our learners are outlined below to ensure learners are aware of how and when they can be contacted. This includes all formal and informal communication and takes the form of individual or group messages. All communication will be saved on the learner's individual learning plan (ILP)

Primary Channels

There are four primary channels of communication: email, phone call, SMS text messaging and whatsapp (group of individuals and voicenotes and to include photos/videos).

Email

This is the preferred method of communication with learners. All learners specify a primary email address for messages relating to the course delivery and for the NEBDN to use to build the Portfolio of evidence/Record of Competence.

Phone/SMS Messaging

In the event that an online session has to be cancelled at short notice a group message will be sent directly to learners via email and text/whatsapp. Learners are responsible for ensuring primary communication channels are checked regularly and no less than weekly. In order to maintain effective and timely communication learners are requested to notify the training centre immediately of any changes to personal contact details or holidays. Whatsapp is increasingly popular now for sending video guidance and voice notes when needed.

Lack of learner progression

This policy applies to all learners enrolled with DNT and outlines the procedures for communication to clarify when the assessor needs to escalate a situation to the course director.

- **Post-Marking Communication:**
After each marking session the learners will be emailed to provide feedback and set expectations for the next session. If feedback or instructions have been documented on PebblePad the learner will be directed to the relevant section. If the learner anticipates being unable to complete the necessary amendments before the next session, they should inform the assessor as soon as possible. Any significant events or observations should be recorded in the learner's Individual Learning Plan (ILP).
- **Lack of Progress:**
If a learner has not made progress or amended their work for three consecutive marking sessions, the mentor will be copied into the communication from the fourth marking session onward.
- **Escalation Process:**
The mentor should be included in the communication for two marking sessions. If there is no response from the mentor and/or the learner does not demonstrate progress, the Lead Internal Quality Assurer (IQA) should be copied into the third email to both the learner and mentor.
- **Assessment of Learner Pathway:**
At this stage, a joint review will be conducted with the Lead IQA and assessor to determine the appropriate next steps for the learner's progression.

REMEDIATION AND POSSIBLE OUTCOMES.

The purpose of remediation plans is to help identify specific problem areas and link them to steps that can produce attainable results once a learner has been found to be falling behind.



In all events where a learner fails to meet the required standard for POE/ROC completion, the learner will be notified by email. The practice mentor will also be involved at the earliest opportunity to help the learner. The learner will meet with the course assessor to discuss and identify areas that need improvement and the expected level of performance, a mentor may be asked to join this session.

The recommended remediation plan will be created by the assigned course assessor/director and developed in conjunction with the learner's mentor. This document is signed by all parties and is a formal agreement that must be adhered to.

The remediation plan may include one or all of the following:

- A study plan designed to focus on specific course content or topics to include watching lectures.
- Structured timeframes to complete work
- Additional surgery time or repeat of practical experience record sheets to focus on competencies.
- Repeat of revision tests, practice assignments or online question banks.
- Extra study time needed at home

Failure to engage with the remediation process or after going through the process, if learners aren't able to demonstrate sufficient knowledge or aren't carrying out the required work to meet the targets, they may be deferred or withdrawn from their course. This decision is made by DNT at their discretion in conjunction with the employing practice.

EXAM ENTRY REQUIREMENT

Dental Nurse Training refers to the entry requirements for learners entering the NEBDN examination. This policy will outline the entry requirements and relevant checks made by Dental Nurse training. We pass NEBDN examination dates to Learners and employers as soon as the NEBDN notify our centre. Full exam guidance is given via email in preparation for the final online exams. Whatsapp voicenotes are also sent by means of complete communication. No course material should be used during exams and no pre-written notes should be taken into an exam. You are permitted to have a blank pen and paper and a drink.

POE/ROC completion is the first step of any course and a learner may not continue to the exam until this has been completed satisfactorily. Learners will then take a single or a series of revision tests before completing a graded Mock Exam whereby a pass rate of 75% is desired.

If the required pass rate is below 65%, the practice and learner will be involved in the decision to continue with entry, deferral or withdrawal. It is rare that we would advise deferring as motivation is lost during the time of waiting for the next exam. Even if results are low, we do encourage learners to continue to sit the exam as long as they are in agreement to do so. If not, we will respect the learner's wishes and defer the exam and a fee will be charged.

With the introduction of the online examinations by the NEBDN, it's important that we, as an accredited course provider align ourselves to the GDC guidance and expectations of these new online systems. A digital exam system reveals interesting trends that would not be seen in paper-based exams.

The NEBDN'S maxexam software also provides the ability to:

- Pair candidates with most suspicious behaviour according to the Harpp & Hogan index
- Identify the number of similarities in both answering correctly, and incorrectly between learners
- Compare timestamped activity between any two given learners and identify suspicious behaviour between the two
- Ability to check the IP address for each candidate

The system analyses individual candidates against the whole of the cohort of learners and identifies pairs of candidates where both candidates have a very similar pattern of behaviour that has taken place during the



exam. Learners must take all exams alone with a working camera and microphone available if the NEBDN request to use these. Dental Nurse Training have no control over the NEBDN's decisions when it comes to examinations and results.

INTERNAL QUALITY ASSURANCE PROCESS

The internal assurance representative (IQA) is a member of the training centre staff employed to assess how the assessor is grading learners' work. We follow a strict protocol in line with the NEBDN guidance.

The IQA will:

- Monitor the assessor's standards of marking throughout the POE/ROC completion.
- Sample all learners POEs & ROCs
- Keep accurate records of all moderation on pebblepad for the assessor to follow up
Make clear and concise notes on pebblepad for the NEBDN to audit when required

NEBDN APPEALS - POLICY/EXAM RESULTS DISPUTES

If a learner is unsuccessful and not happy with the results of the final exam, Dental Nurse Training will act on behalf of the learner in requesting an appeal to be made regarding NEBDN exam decisions. Full details on NEBDN Appeals can be found on their website.

If the learner fails to complete an NEBDN mandatory practice test, the NEBDN will defer them automatically to the next exam, DNT has no control over this. At each examination entry stage, DNT assesses if that learner still falls within the following GDC guidance and checks their eligibility for the next exam:

- *The trainee should achieve their award, or qualification, within the normal duration of the course or up to one year after the expected course completion date.*

If learners fall outside of this guidance, they will need to apply for a new ROC/POE and start their training again. In extreme cases, learners may be removed from the centre; every opportunity is given to a learner before this happens. The assessor/assessor, along with the course director will decide if a learner is able to meet all requirements to fulfil exam entry, without assessor/assessor confirmation learners will not be entered into the exam. The lead IQA will carry out a full assessment of the online portfolio before submitting exam entry paperwork to the NEBDN.

NEBDN APPEALS - MALPRACTICE OR INVESTIGATION OUTCOMES

If a learner is subject to an NEBDN malpractice investigation or is issued with an outcome following such an investigation, learners have the right to appeal the decision in line with NEBDN appeals procedures.

Learners must notify Dental Nurse Training (DNT) in writing of their intention to appeal within 10 working days of receiving the NEBDN decision.

- Upon receipt of an appeal request, DNT will:
- Acknowledge the appeal within 5 working days
- Request any additional supporting evidence from the learner
- Review the information to ensure it is appropriate and relevant
- Submit the appeal and supporting documentation directly to the NEBDN on the learner's behalf

The learner is responsible for providing clear evidence to support their appeal. This may include:

- A written statement
- Evidence of mitigating circumstances
- Any supporting documentation relevant to the investigation



The NEBDN will review the appeal and communicate the outcome. DNT has no authority to overturn NEBDN decisions.

Please note:

- Appeals submitted outside of the 10 working day timeframe may not be accepted.
- The NEBDN decision following an appeal is final.
- In order for an appeal to be submitted, learners must provide relevant and additional evidence to support their case. Where no new or relevant evidence is provided, or where the original decision is based on clear and objective evidence, Dental Nurse Training will advise the learner that an appeal is unlikely to be successful.

In such cases, DNT may decline to submit the appeal on the learner's behalf. The learner will be informed of this decision in writing within 5 days.

Full policy can be reviewed here [Malpractice, Maladministration, and Plagiarism Policy - Dental Nurse Training Ltd](#)

EXAM RE-SIT

The re-sit paperwork cannot be processed by the NEBDN until the fee has been paid to us. The type of revision offered will depend on what sections the learner failed in the examination, along with each individual learner's needs, the responsibility for this decision will be made between the course director and learner. Learners will be allowed to re-sit their exams twice if required. After this time, a meeting will be arranged to discuss why the candidate has been unable to pass the exam. A decision will be made at that meeting as to whether the learner is suitable to continue with their training or whether they need to be withdrawn from the centre and find an alternative route of training. If meetings are requested by the learner before this time DNT will arrange this and are open to any support that can be requested within reason.

For the regulated diploma the NEBDN allow three re-sits for the knowledge test and the professional discussion.

DEFERRAL OF EXAMS

There are times when a learner is unable to meet the target exam date chosen. If a learner chooses to defer their exam then there is a fee charged by the NEBDN and by us as a provider. Our charges cover administration, extra assessor and marking time and continued support leading up to the next exam. On occasions, deferral is unavoidable due to circumstances beyond a learner's control. If this is the case we can apply to the NEBDN for 'extenuating circumstances'.

COURSE WITHDRAWAL

All deferral and withdrawal decisions are reviewed by the Course Director and communicated in writing to the learner and employing practice.

Withdrawal of trainee dental nurses from the NEBDN Diploma Course may jeopardise your employment within the practice.

POST CERTIFICATE COURSE PAYMENTS

Post-certificate courses are paid for at the time of application unless otherwise agreed with us in advance. Places are non-transferable and non-refundable once the induction has been completed.

COMPLAINTS & APPEALS

The purpose of this procedure is to specify the process for dealing with any complaints or appeals that may arise.



If a learner has a complaint or raises an appeal relating to any aspect of his or her assessment or training, Dental Nurse Training encourages the learner to try to settle the complaint informally by raising it with their assessor or a member of the training team in the first instance.

If the learner does not wish to raise the matter informally or if a complaint or appeal raised informally has not been resolved, they may wish to take the matter further by raising a formal complaint or appeal.

All complaints or appeals should be submitted in writing to Dental Nurse Training for the attention of the Course Director, together with any supporting evidence, via email to info@dentalnurse.training within 10 working days of an assessment outcome, exam withdrawal/deferral or termination of the training placement.

We aim to respond to all complaints within 10 working days. If a complaint is about any of the course assessors it will be referred to the person concerned, unless the complainant does not want this to happen. We will offer to discuss the complaint at a time agreed with the complainant in the hope of reaching a resolution. We will keep the complainant informed of all developments.

We will inform the complainant the estimated time that the investigation will take to be completed. This can be done by whichever of the following methods is preferred by the complainant: telephone, face to face meetings, letters or email.

We will endeavour to investigate speedily and efficiently as far as reasonably practicable. Normally, the process should take no longer than a month from beginning to end. When we have completed our investigation, we will provide you with a full written report. The report will include an explanation of how the complaint has been considered, the conclusions reached in respect of each specific complaint, details of any necessary remedial action that needs to be or already has been taken.

If a complaint remains unresolved or the complainant is not satisfied with the results of our procedure then the learner may appeal to:

National Examining Board for Dental Nurses, First Floor, Quayside Court, Chain Caul Way, Preston PR2 2ZP.

Please note that the NEBDN are not able to get involved in any monetary disputes between the learner and the training centre.

INCIDENT REPORTING – IN PRACTICE

Every employer will have an incident reporting policy designed to outline the purpose and procedure for reporting any on-the-job accidents. This would have been communicated as part of your induction process when starting with your employer. The purpose of these policies are to enforce all health and safety guidelines to avoid such occurrences and expects employees to comply.

However, accidents are sometimes inevitable; provision in this case is to ensure all accidents are reported timely so they can be investigated properly and preventative measures can be reviewed and reinforced.

On-the-job accidents must be reported and include any incidents that may cause minor or severe injuries or incidents that are results of negligence or inadequate safety precautions.

Employees are also required to report occurrences that may not have involved injuries or victims but could be potentially dangerous in that respect if repeated.

All accidents must be reported as soon as possible under your own practice policies to expedite investigation and increase likelihood of important findings.

The sooner the cause or details of the accident are identified, the sooner the employer can establish preventative measures for the future.

LEARNER SUPPORT & WELLBEING POLICY (5.3 ref to NEBDN standards)



Learners may find at times that the life/work balance is not right and that the course they have taken on is too much for them to complete within the set timeframes. Reasons for this may include but not limited to the following:

- Suffering from mental health
- Personal problems impacting their private life
- Work stress has increased, meaning studies are being put to one side

We recommend that if the above happens, learners speak to the assessor at their earliest convenience to explain the problems they are facing and together look for a solution/plan.

This plan may include:

- Having a break from studies, this may include deferring an exam date
- Extending the POE/ROC deadline if possible before the exam is due
- Terminating training as a last resort or if the learner decides this option
- Providing Reasonable adjustments to exam conditions

As a centre we take pride in caring about our learners and making sure we support them at every possible step. We will always try to work around problems the learners are having and make manageable plans to suit their needs, at times this is not always possible but it will never be without exhausting every option first on our part.

If you are suffering from any mental health problems, we would like to know about them as this may mean our approach to your learning is adapted. In addition, we encourage learners to get external support from their GP and referral services

Below are some links learners may find useful

<https://dentalnurse.training/wp-content/uploads/2022/07/Mental-Health-Resource-Toolkit.pdf>

<https://dentalnurse.training/wp-content/uploads/2022/07/How-to-Talk-with-Employees-About-Mental-Health-Problems.pdf>

If a learner has concerns about the performance of any assessors, staff or supervisors or finding difficulties in their workplace, it is good practice for there to be a simple reporting policy which is outlined so that everyone knows who to speak to and what will be done.

We encourage learners to familiarise themselves with their own employers raising concerns policy as well our own policy outlined in the Learner Handbook

PLAGIARISM POLICY

Plagiarism means that learners are not demonstrating their own understanding and learning in assessment, and can gain an unfair advantage over other learners by submitting work not their own. The level of intent to deceive and the extent of the plagiarism should be the criteria for determining penalties.

Dental Nurse Training has an obligation to the NEBDN, the learners, the employers to ensure that plagiarism does not allow learners to attain qualifications that do not accurately represent their own knowledge and skills. Plagiarism may also be seen as a breach of trust between staff and learners, and between individual learners. We take all appropriate measures to ensure that learners' submitted work is their own, and that plagiarism and other forms of cheating have not taken place.

It is the responsibility of all learners to ensure that submitted work, especially for the purposes of summative assessment, is their own.

All learners have a responsibility to prevent cheating and plagiarism by:



- Ensuring that they have a sound knowledge of what cheating and plagiarism is
- Produce original work with appropriate and correct citations
- Acknowledge others work correctly

ASSESSOR LEARNER RATIOS

This policy sets out the guidelines for assessor-to-learner ratios at Dental Nurse Training Ltd. It ensures that all learners receive high-quality education, support, and assessment in line with the course content, specific learner needs, progression, and attainment. This policy is designed to maintain effective learning experiences while promoting professional development for newly qualified assessors/assessors.

Standard Ratio:

An assessor will be responsible for a maximum of 1:17 learners per assessment day.

Newly Qualified Assessor/Assessor Ratio:

A newly qualified assessor/assessor will be responsible for a maximum of 1:10 learners per assessment day.



These ratios have been established based on:

Course Content: Ensuring that the complexity of dental nursing education is adequately supported by an appropriate assessor-to-learner ratio.

Specific Learner Needs: Providing additional support where necessary to cover diverse learning requirements.

Progression & Attainment: Allowing sufficient interaction and guidance to enable learners to achieve their qualifications effectively.

Quality Assurance: Ensuring compliance with regulatory requirements and maintaining high standards of training delivery.

Implementation & Review

assessors must adhere to the set ratios to ensure optimal learning conditions.

The Course Director will monitor compliance with this policy through regular reviews and feedback mechanisms.

This policy will be reviewed annually to ensure it aligns with industry standards and the evolving needs of learners and educators.

Exceptions & Adjustments

In cases where additional support is required due to learner needs, adjustments may be made with the approval of the Course Director.

Any deviations from the prescribed ratios must be documented and justified in accordance with quality assurance processes.

TRAINING FEES

All fees, when a learner joins a course, will include full support from the application through to the chosen exam date. Unfortunately, circumstances arise and things can change throughout a training journey.

To maintain transparency, this policy explains situations that may occur throughout the training. Please see our fees list or contact us via email to clarify fees if you have a situation that has arisen.

Employers paying for the learner's training are advised to make trainees fully aware of the arrangements with regards to payment should a trainee leave employment/the enrolled course. Likewise trainees are advised to ensure they are also aware of the agreement they have entered into with the practice that has paid.

We do not get involved with any monetary agreements between practices and the trainee. Please make sure you are all fully aware of the obligations to us as a centre. If a trainee moves practices partway through training we would still be able to train this person as our fees would have been paid.

We pride ourselves on being fair to the practices that we work with and the learners that we train. It is rare that a learner moves practices midway through the course but transparency from the outset is important.

DIPLOMA IN DENTAL NURSING PAYMENTS

The deposit is non-refundable and non-transferable under any circumstance. This secures the learner's place on the course and enables them to acquire a certificate of proof of registration to begin their training with an accredited centre. It also enables us to prepare for the number of assessors needed for that cohort.



Invoice must be paid within 28 days of being issued

POST CERTIFICATE COURSE PAYMENTS

Post-certificate courses are paid for at the time of application unless otherwise agreed with us in advance. Places are non-transferable and non-refundable once the induction has been completed.

REFUNDS

It is expected that a trainee is fully aware of their job role, the practice that they are working in and that they are ready to begin training with us by the time of their induction session. DNT will have already had a call with the practice and learners before the induction date. The Diploma in Dental Nursing course has a cooling-off period of 7 days from the date the induction is carried out, if, within these 7 days the practice/learner decides not to continue with their training, we will issue a refund, minus any costs already incurred (See fees list). The request must be made by the practice or self-funding learner via email, texts and calls will not be accepted. Requests for refunds are not accepted after the cooling-off period.

Once a post-certificate course has been paid for and the induction is completed, there are no refunds for these courses. If a post-certificate learner does not have an induction and the ROC has not been applied for, then they may request a refund within 28 days of the payment.

Any NEBDN fees already paid in relation to POE/ROCs are non-refundable to the centre, and this fee is passed on to the person/practice that has paid.

PAYMENT AGREEMENTS

Learners and practices can enter into a goodwill payment agreement with us. Payments are ideally paid in full before the course begins, but if this is not possible, whoever takes on the agreement is bound to pay the full amount even if they choose to leave the course before it has been paid in full. The agreed plan will be invoiced with dates and amounts via email. These need to be adhered to at all times.

An overpayment of an instalment can be made, but no underpayments. The following instalment will still need to be paid as agreed.

In the event of an unpaid instalment the course director will contact the person via email and give them 7 days to pay the fee. If after 7 days the fee has not been paid and the course director is not satisfied there is a valid reason for non-payment then the learner will be removed from the training centre at our discretion.

TRANSFERRING TO DNT FROM ANOTHER CENTRE

Occasionally, learners ask to join our centre midway through their training with another centre. We will discuss the learners circumstances with them before agreeing to take them on. If we mutually agree to proceed, the learners existing POE/ROC will be assessed and they will be told what we can offer in terms of support and course material. This will then be confirmed via email along with the fee prior to enrolling with our centre.

Any work completed by the previous centre will be checked by DNT to ensure a valid witness certificate is attached but we will not check the content of the learner's work as this has been signed off by the previous NEBDN accredited centre. A comment will be made in the assessor comments section to reflect this.

MOVING EMPLOYMENT DURING TRAINING

On occasions, learners choose to move practices midway through their training. We encourage learners to discuss this with us before handing in their notice as we want to make sure all options are offered before the learner decides. If a learner moves practice a new induction session and Service monitoring agreement needs to be completed.

EXCESSIVE TIMEWASTING/EXTENSION TO ROC/POE DEADLINES



If a learner has been given a remediation plan/target to meet and we find that there is still marking to complete beyond the agreement deadline then a fee will apply. The practice/learner will be notified that this will happen well in advance of the charges are applied. (See DNT fee list)

Please follow the links to view the following policies that relate to staff and learners

DATA PROTECTION POLICY (1.4 ref to NEBDN standards)

<https://dentalnurse.training/data-protection-policy/>

FREEDOM OF INFORMATION (FOI) ACT POLICY (1.4 ref to NEBDN standards)

<https://dentalnurse.training/freedom-of-information/>

EQUAL DIVERSITY AND INCLUSION (1.4 ref to NEBDN standards)

<https://dentalnurse.training/equality-diversity-and-inclusion/>

DUTY OF CANDOUR (1.9 ref to NEBDN standards)

<https://dentalnurse.training/duty-of-candour/>

FITNESS TO PRACTICE (1.9 – 1.10 ref to NEBDN standards)

<https://dentalnurse.training/fitness-to-practice/>

HEALTH & SAFETY POLICY FOR REMOTE STAFF AND LEARNERS (1.4 ref to NEBDN standards)

<https://dentalnurse.training/health-and-safety/>

MALPRACTICE, MALADMINISTRATION, AND PLAGIARISM POLICY (1.1, 1.9, 1.10 ref to NEBDN standards)

<https://dentalnurse.training/malpractice-maladministration-and-plagiarism-policy/>

RAISING CONCERNS AND WHISTLEBLOWING (1.9-1.10 ref to NEBDN standards)

<https://dentalnurse.training/raising-concerns-and-whistleblowing/>

PATIENT SAFETY POLICY FOR REMOTE ASSESSORS MONITORING DENTAL NURSE TRAINEES (1.10 ref to NEBDN standards)

<https://dentalnurse.training/patient-safety-policy-for-remote-assessors-monitoring-trainees/>

REASONABLE ADJUSTMENTS, Special Considerations & Fair Access Policy (1.4 ref to NEBDN standards)

<https://dentalnurse.training/reasonable-adjustments-special-considerations-and-fair-access/>

SOCIAL MEDIA POLICY (1.10 ref to NEBDN standards)

<https://dentalnurse.training/social-media-policy/>